

Choose the Right CIAM for your Integration Architecture

The last article in the series had explored Gigya and Janrain, covering aspects like their flexible architecture that enables integrating an enterprise digital solution for CIAM requirements. In this article, we will cover ForgeRock, IBM Federated Identity Management, PingIdentity and Stormpath.



The ForgeRock solution provides interactive profile and privacy widgets as user-specific dashboards for continuous monitoring and task handling purposes. This is in compliance with EU's Data Privacy Policy and GDPR. ForgeRock is one of the preferred partners for banking IT solutions due to its support for frictionless user experiences (UX) and real-time identity context, which optimises the Omnichannel experience throughout the user journey.

ForgeRock provides distributed policy management, which can be customised with the flexible data source schema and API design. Hence, handling policy management across different user instances of connected application sources, including social networking identities, is quite flexible with ForgeRock based implementation.

The main factors that influence people to choose

- User notifications
 - Offline and online approval/rejection
 - Customisation of API and data source/schema available
 - Since ForgeRock is open source, any kind of customisation is possible, including API redesign
- The five major components of the ForgeRock integrated architecture are listed below.

- OpenAM: An access management solution
- OpenIDM: An identity life cycle management system
- OpenDJ: This is for directory services
- OpenIG: This is an application gateway
- OpenICF: This offers cloud identity connectors

Apart from these, ForgeRock provides custom REST API interfaces to integrate with any enterprise solution to invoke any of the above connectors/handlers.

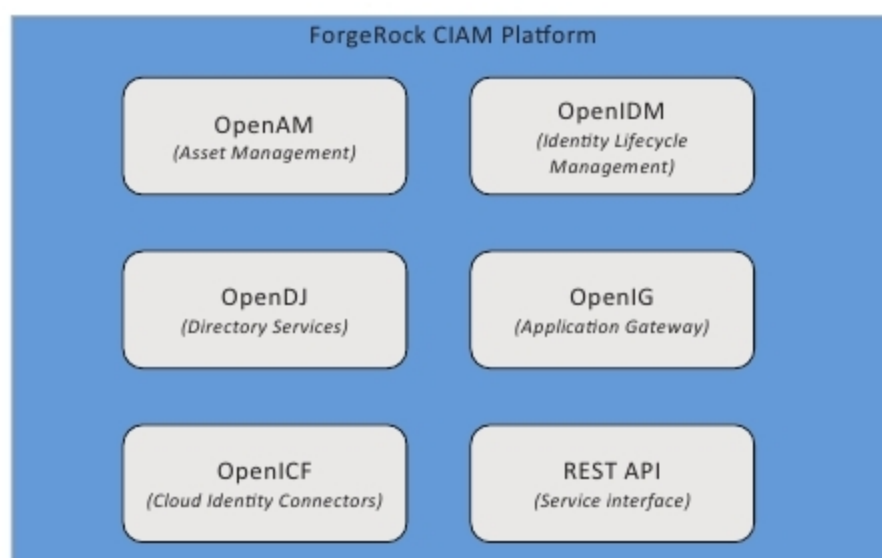


Figure 1: The ForgeRock CIAM platform solution

ForgeRock as a CIAM (Customer Identity and Access Management Solution), solution are listed below:

- Customisable, with the flexibility to adopt at runtime

IBM Federated Identity Management (FIM)

IBM's Cloud Identity Service and Security Access Manager has been ranked as the leader among CIAM solutions at the Leadership Compass 2017. It is a multi-tenant, fully cloud based identity service with integrated services for security, functionality, integration, interoperability and usability. It is designed to excel in business-to-consumer (B2C) use cases because it is a highly available cloud offering with a robust suite of self-service applications, and can rapidly scale in scenarios with millions of external users.

Some of the factors influencing the choice of IBM FIM as a CIAM solution are:

- Principle and rights management
- Identity access management
- Workflow of user operations
- Context based access control
- Policy based authentication